



Jack Pieters was born and raised in the town of Cedar Falls, Iowa. During his time studying Environmental Policy & Planning and minoring in Geographic Information Systems at the University of Iowa, he spent his summers exploring the beautiful public lands in the Western US- namely in Polebridge, MT and Steamboat Springs, CO. He collaborated on conservation projects with the Forest Service, Bureau of Land Management, and local NGOs through the Rocky Mountain Youth Corps for two summers- one as a crew member, one as an assistant crew leader.

On top of his academic involvement in Iowa City, Jack worked with UI's research prairie, Ashton Prairie Living Laboratory. Jack gained valuable field experience here and helped tackle various issues of data management and organization to streamline future research. These seasons out West, the EPPL program, and the Ashton Prairie at Iowa have all coalesced into an interest in renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, and the land and energy policy that shapes both.